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Submitter Information

Name: Kris Knigge

General Comment

See attached file(s)

Attachments

AI Action Plan

March 15th, 2025

From:

Kris Knigge

Freelance Localization Specialist and Adaptation Writer

Re: National Science Foundation's Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan

I am an everyday American who owns a small localization business which serves clients in the entertainment industry. I have worked hard for years to develop the skills and knowledge to build my business, and have been lucky enough to make a decent living and support my family – until recently.

The AI systems made by Big Tech companies like OpenAI (Microsoft) and Google threaten to destroy thousands of American small businesses like mine with their recent demand to create special carve outs in copyright law.

AI systems can only be produced by first training on work made by people. My unique work, and the work of hundreds of thousands of other everyday American creators was taken and fed into these AI systems without our consent or any compensation. They ingest our work, reassemble it, and then sell it back to our clients – directly competing with us and cutting us out of the marketplace.

Now these Big Tech companies are asking this administration to create exceptions and loopholes to make this practice of stealing American creators' copyrighted work legal precedent. They are suggesting that if a machine ingests and reproduces copyrighted work, it is somehow suddenly "fair use".

They seem to believe that anything and everything on the internet – regardless of who owns it – should be theirs for the taking. They claim that if this administration does not allow them to rewrite the law in this way, it will stifle American innovation.

Instead, it will have the opposite effect. The purpose of American copyright law is to protect the incentive to create and innovate.

If we the American people do not own our creations, and everything we put online will be stolen by Big Tech giants, what will be the incentive to create? If everyday Americans create a new innovative piece of computer code, a new visual design, or a new piece of music only to have it immediately stolen by Google and Microsoft, why bother creating it in the first place? How will we possibly make a living doing these things?

Want to protect American innovation? Protect American creators. **Do not create new copyright exemptions that allow Big Tech companies to exploit and steal from creators and everyday Americans without permission, compensation, or transparency.**

There are some who are using this letter as a base who will tell you that they are impressed by the potential of generative AI, and that they're looking to you to create a system that involves asking creators to consent to their work being fed into these machines. I am not impressed by the potential of generative AI, nor do I want any work fed into them. Any technology that cannot operate without stolen material is not worth supporting. **I'd rather my work be pirated than used to power AI to take jobs from my colleagues and people who will enter this field in the future.**

I do not trust Big Tech to do right by creatives. I do not trust them to abide by the law. But if you work to uphold copyright, to demand transparency, and to financially reimburse the creators whose work they devour, I'll feel a little less distressed about the future.

Thank you for the opportunity to comment on these important issues.

-Kris Knigge